

**Table 1** Small-world example for explaining top 50, 25, and 10% cited references in citing years

| RPY = 1970                                 | Publication year of citing publication |       |       |       |       |       | Results  |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|----------|
|                                            | 1980                                   | 1981  | 1982  | 1983  | 1984  | 1985  | N_PYEARS |
| CR A                                       | 6 11                                   | 5 11  | 0 22  | 17 41 | 24 62 | 21 45 | 5        |
| CR B                                       | 9 18                                   | 9 23  | 5 24  | 10 23 | 8 27  | 9 17  | 6        |
| CR C                                       | 20 54                                  | 34 54 | 0 50  | 16 21 | 5 27  | 6 11  | 5        |
| CR D                                       | 6 16                                   | 10 31 | 15 50 | 25 55 | 15 45 | 5 20  | 6        |
| Sorted cells in ascending order (rows)     |                                        |       |       |       |       |       |          |
|                                            | 6 11                                   | 5 11  | 0 22  | 10 21 | 5 27  | 5 11  |          |
|                                            | 6 16                                   | 9 23  | 0 24  | 16 23 | 8 27  | 6 17  |          |
|                                            | 9 18                                   | 10 31 | 5 50  | 17 41 | 15 45 | 9 20  |          |
|                                            | 20 54                                  | 34 54 | 15 50 | 25 55 | 24 62 | 21 45 |          |
| Limits for identifying top publications    |                                        |       |       |       |       |       |          |
| Top 50%                                    | 6 16                                   | 9 23  | 0 24  | 16 23 | 8 27  | 6 17  |          |
| Top 75%                                    | 9 18                                   | 10 31 | 5 50  | 17 41 | 15 45 | 9 20  |          |
| Top 90%                                    | 9 18                                   | 10 31 | 5 50  | 17 41 | 15 45 | 9 45  |          |
| Values below and above the limit (top 50%) |                                        |       |       |       |       |       | N_TOP50  |
| CR A                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 0 0   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 3 3      |
| CR B                                       | 1 1                                    | 0 0   | 1 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 1 0   | 3 1      |
| CR C                                       | 1 1                                    | 1 1   | 0 1   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 2 3      |
| CR D                                       | 0 0                                    | 1 1   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 0 1   | 4 5      |
| Values below and above the limit (top 25%) |                                        |       |       |       |       |       | N_TOP25  |
| CR A                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 2 2      |
| CR B                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0      |
| CR C                                       | 1 1                                    | 1 1   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 2 2      |
| CR D                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 1 0   | 1 1   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 2 1      |
| Values below and above the limit (top 10%) |                                        |       |       |       |       |       | N_TOP10  |
| CR A                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 1 1   | 1 1   | 2 2      |
| CR B                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0      |
| CR C                                       | 1 1                                    | 1 1   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 2 2      |
| CR D                                       | 0 0                                    | 0 0   | 1 0   | 1 1   | 0 0   | 0 0   | 2 1      |